Social Sector Internship Report

HCL Foundation- Sports for Change

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Submitted in partial fulfilment of the Bachelor of Management Studies (BMS) of the School of Management and Entrepreneurship, Shiv Nadar University

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

In the year of 2016 Rio Olympics, India sent its largest ever Olympic contingent comprising 118 athletes. Despite the large number of athletes, the Indian contingent managed to bag only 2 medals in the Games. In the 2020 Olympics, India secured Four bronze medals, two silvers, and one prestigious Olympic gold. The Indian contingent executed an impressive overall performance accomplishing the country's biggest medal tally in the history of the Olympics.

Considering the size of our country it can be said that the 2020 performance was not up to the country's potential. Specific steps need to be taken to realise the full sporting potential of India in games represented in Olympics and Commonwealth Games, as well as forthcoming international sporting events.

HCL Foundation provides young athletes hailing from underprivileged sections a holistic experience through its various projects under Sports for Change. It is focused on providing the child with proper sporting knowledge, educating and enabling the child to become independent in future. Sponsored academies run by HCL Foundation create employment opportunities which positively impact society. The foundation intends to provide exposure and sponsorships to children after identifying best athletes in its national tournaments. Athletes are also provided with essential experience if they progress and reach a higher degree of play, such as representation in National and International events with their respective sports.

I was selected in HCL Foundation to work alongside my manager Mr. Manu Khanna (Manager – Sports for Change at HCL Foundation). Mr Manu is a member of the CSR arm of HCL Technologies. He implements a large-scale sports program for the underprivileged kids PAN India. As an intern, I worked directly under Mr Manu's guidance and instructions with the entire team of HCL Foundation in their

office during my tenure. I accomplished the task of making meaningful contributions to the events scheduled for Sports for Change during my internship tenure. I executed a variety of diverse tasks frequently changing from logistics, planning, organisation and event management. I utilised my adaptation skills, hardworking and focused mentality to complete tasks at hand.

During my time with the organization, I learnt a lot of things. A highlight was the importance of teamwork and planning, as it has the capability to exponentially increase the reach of the organization far beyond local advocates. Knowing the importance and need for improvement for sporting culture in India, I was quite happy and motivated to work with HCL Foundation. I felt comfortable working and staying with my team all my tenure. I thoroughly enjoyed working in office with my team.

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LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

1. HCL – Hindustan Computers Limited
2. HCLF – Hindustan Computers Limited Foundation
3. SFC – Sports for Change
4. SSI – Social Sector Internship
5. SNU – Shiv Nadar University
6. VNIT - Visvesvaraya National Institute of Technology

Introduction

The Indian and state governments comprise athletes from underprivileged parts of India. Many of these sports have their origins in the long-standing Indian sporting culture. The Indian and state governments have recently launched a number of efforts to prepare athletes for careers in professional sports. However, there is still a long way to go before India becomes a great sporting power. Sports must be a component of a child's development as they grow. A window of opportunity exists to include athletics as a mandatory component of the curriculum in schools and colleges according to the National Education Policy 2020. Sports may be scaled up to each family thanks to the network of schools and universities that serves as an ideal platform. Future champions can be produced through tangible programmes improving grass root development i.e. provision of scholarships for talented hard working athletes, improvement of sporting facilities & infrastructure and experience exposure on a large scale.

Here by, I introduce HCLF's special initiative Sports for Change.

Mission

Aimed at enabling balanced participation, excellence and holistic development through a high-quality and inclusive sporting experience for children and youth from disadvantaged communities.

Vision

- Harnessing the positive transformative potential of sports by bridging the access-gap and promoting participation in sports at the grassroots **(right to play).**
- Promoting play or sports at grassroots, as a means to help achieve larger development goals **(linking sports with development outcomes).**

- Empowering young leaders from disadvantaged communities by channelizing their energy towards play and sports **(creating role models).**
- Providing participating young athletes, a safe well rounded positive environment to showcase their attributes without any fear (**Inspiring athletes**).

Performance of the organisation

Since its inception in 2015 as a volunteer-led initiative in Chennai, Sports for Change focuses on supporting and nurturing young sporting talent.

- 21,000+ athletes reached
- 113 sports scholars recognized through scholarships
- 89 students got admission in reputed colleges through sports quota
- 104 students participated in State/ National level competitions

Introduction to the project

I was given the opportunity to work as an intern in HCL Foundation

alongside my boss Mr. Manu Khanna (Manager, Sports for Change at HCL Foundation, CSR arm of HCL Technologies) for implementing large scale sports program for the underprivileged kids PAN India. I worked directly in Mr Manu's guidance and instructions with the entire team of HCL Foundation in their office, my tenure from June 13th June to 25th June.

Sports for Change had 2 events scheduled in the months of June and July.

1. SFC North Zone Sports Championship 2022, 21st-22nd June, conducted at Shiv Nadar University, Greater Noida
2. SFC National Finals 2022, 21st - 22nd July, conducted at Visvesvaraya National Institute of Technology, Nagpur

- I executed my role as a Core Organising Committee member for both tournaments.
- As the nature of work was extremely diverse and demanded different methods and patterns of analysis & improvisation to complete work at hand. I, therefore, performed a variety of diverse tasks frequently changing from planning, logistics, organisation and event management.
- My responsibilities before the tournaments were primarily towards allocation and planning of resources, analysing & scheduling travel of participants, infrastructure requirements at venues for sports and registration requirements of students.
- My responsibilities of work during both the tournaments was different from the work before the tournaments.

Objective of the project

- Ensure smooth preparation and execution for both events on time.
- Produce analysis and resource reporting requirements for the events.
- Supplement and support our team with roles and responsibilities assigned during the tournaments:
    1. Accommodation of participants and supporting staff in hostels
    2. Registration of entire teams.
    3. Passing on travelling and accommodation information to participants.
    4. Making toilets user friendly for teams from different parts of India through use of image posters on toilets on how to use a western toilet.
    5. Did match organisation, venue management, tournament conduction overall as Technical Directors for Football.
    6. Catering to participant emergencies and transportation to medical facilities due to injuries or sickness.

7. Transfer of equipment to venues
8. Inventory management of sporting equipment handed to participants during registration.
9. Assessment and preparation of invites and for referees and chief guests to witness the games.
10. Prepare documentation for event and venue rules and equipment to be carried for the games

Methodology

Planning, analysing, allocating and resource reporting are necessary for all organizations, especially for a company like HCL Foundation. These help ensure preparation and timely arrangement of logistics necessary for any events or requirements coming ahead for the organization.

A well-oiled machine requires the understanding of its components. In Sports for Change, a lot of pre-work is put into analysing and arranging for requirements. Quality checks are carried out to ensure that products such as sporting venues, if not up to the desired quality mark, can be replaced with alternatives which have already been prepared and communicated with quotations through sellers.

Planning drastically improves the communication by spreading knowledge throughout members of the organization as well as employees nation-wide working towards the same objective. With all that in mind, I worked my way through to carry and fulfill the goals and responsibilities for the organization in an efficient and creative manner.

1. Daily and weekly work schedules
   On my notepad, I would plan out the entire day and set up a daily agenda. Most of the time, I would make adjustments and note changes in accordance with my regular agenda. I would evaluate my progress, organise my daily tasks, and then prioritise them. This allowed for efficiency and organisation.

2. Closely assessing the nature of tasks for projects

In order to start working on any task, it is important to gather qualitative as well as quantitative information regarding the task. If a task required gathering or collection of data, such as travel, I would collect or analyse the data using excel sheets. For general tasks such as research on chief guests to invite, I would make physical notes and prepare a summary. Tasks such as determining the size of branding (used to promote the company during the event) required more reference material such as a tile or any object whose dimensions were known. There was always a need to adjust the data collection method according to the task at hand and the desired output.

3. Ensuring the correct and desired information result is provided.
   The next step is to transfer the information or result to the requester appropriately. In organizations, people rely heavily on information which is provided by another source. Hence, it is important to cross check the information which is outgoing. Frequently, I had to modify the information I was delivering. Therefore, I always seek feedback and new instructions for the task at hand from my seniors. Communication with my peers was extremely crucial, who were happy to help me with any issue I encountered.

4. Application of management principles.
   A social-work sports initiative intern requires a significant amount of management skills. I was able to fulfill my tasks through these skills, a few of which I learnt in my college courses. Principles such as: -
   - Strategic management for solutions and developing plans and policies designed to achieve objectives and then allocating resources to implement the plans.

- Time management for not affecting the supply chain of work, adjusting impromptu tasks and avoidance of pile ups.
- Teamwork for collective completion of tasks and understanding a supply chain.
- Marketing for a general outlook to how an audience may/will perceive any decision presented by the organisation.
- Business Ethics was a key component as our events majorly consisted of kids under the age of 18. It was important to comply with company guidelines on how to interact and behave on events. It was a big focus during discussions with my team and clients.
- As part of a Sports initiative it isn't compulsory to have economics and sporting knowledge, but it may sometimes help. Once, I had the tasks of analysing and cumulating total amount of sporting equipment for each sport. This responsibility came during the July event in Nagpur. The work was sent from a different office of HCL Foundation in Chennai.
- As an athlete myself, I noticed that in certain sports, equipment desired was upwards by approximately 3 or 4 units in each category than the standard amount of equipment required. Such decisions may lead to wasteful usage of money and may drive up costs through the requirement of storage facilities for the non- or under-utilised products and reduce the overall budget.

I feel it is beneficial to possess similar if not the same skills for a project "Sports for Change" run by an organization HCL Foundation.

Analysis and Results

After interning at HCL Foundation, I can confidently say that I learnt a lot more than I expected. Apart from the great experience of working as a Sports Management intern, I learnt the importance of management and planning. Additionally, I realised the significance for any organization to plan, execute and deliver. I have grown significantly wiser and knowledgeable in various departments through practical application of concepts and ideas through this internship.

Reports of the events

1. SFC North Zone Sports Championship 2022 conducted at Shiv Nadar University, Greater Noida was the accumulation of the Uttar Pradesh state and zonal championships. 200+ participants from various districts of UP such as Hardoi and Lucknow and more were provided accommodation and played across 12 sports badminton, athletics, basketball, carrom, chess, cricket, football, kabaddi, rugby, table tennis, volleyball and wrestling in both boy's and girl's categories.

- Our event turned out to be a success as we achieved high standards of competition with great sporting infrastructure present in Shiv Nadar University which let us use sports venues and the Indoor Sports Complex (ISC) free of cost. We as a team were allotted responsibilities such as in a particular sport or a department like medical, dining hall, hostel, backend, equipment etc. Referees were invited through district federations to ensure quality of matches being conducted for every sport. Only charging for the accommodation and food facilities. We were able to save money and deliver a tournament of great quality.

- Staff from SNU were immensely helpful in helping us conduct the games. Mr. Amrish Tony (Director of Physical Education), Mr. Gaurav Bhardwaj (Hostel representative), Mr Pawan Negi and Mr Gopal Karunakaran are few people who helped us transition this event into a success. They actively communicated, provided permissions and helped us.
- All matches were recorded by a videography team and showcased live on streaming platforms like Youtube etc.
- The event concluded with a closing ceremony where various SNU's dignitaries, along with the District Sporting Officer of Gautam Buddh Nagar along with HCL Foundation Director Nidhi Pundhir were present to witness the ceremony.
- Even though there were various challenges such as extreme heat in June, medical emergencies, unfamiliarity with the college environment for HCLF staff and daily working hours for 12-13 hours daily during the event, it didn't derail the tournament.
- Adequate arrangements were made to tackle the heat which included multiple water stations equipped with Glucose to hydrate players. A stand-by ambulance was available to carry any student to the blue circle if necessary or even to the hospital if the symptoms were high grade. Decent accommodation was offered in the Eagle's nest for each employee.
- As perfection isn't a destination it's a journey. We could have better geared ourselves to a few possibilities. Few students were participating in multiple events going on at the same time as per scheduling. Hence students had to finish one sport in its entirety then rush to the other venue. We were aware of these situations as our team was communicating all the time on the same frequency on walkie-talkies. We could have arranged scheduling to adjust situations as such. A few students from Jammu & Kashmir after playing in the afternoon matches

fainted on the ground due to heat strokes. The climate experienced in their region is much different to conditions present here. We can't change the weather but ensure the performance of an athlete. Perhaps, we could run an expected climate report for the region of the games to prepare coaches to acclimatise to regions better with hydration and health guidance.

2. SFC National Finals 2022, 21st - 22nd July, conducted at Visvesvaraya National Institute of Technology, Nagpur was the accumulation of all state and regional tournaments. Qualified teams consisting of about 400+ participants were provided accommodation and played in the national level event where teams from states (Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Jammu & Kashmir, Madhya Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Nagaland, Maharashtra, Karnataka, HCL Foundation [Team assembled of past best performing players in previous editions and Sudeva [Residential football academy from Delhi] participated across these 12 sports badminton, athletics, basketball, carrom, chess, cricket, football, kabaddi, rugby, table tennis, volleyball and wrestling in both boys and girls categories.

- Our entire team arrived on the 19th here in Nagpur. We had our accommodation this time outside the campus. We couldn't conduct the entire tournament in VNIT campus due to heavy rainfalls leading to degradation of outdoor sports such as boy's football. Transportation became a key aspect for teams travelling to venues outside college for matches on time. VNIT, similar to SNU, presented a big campus with excellent sporting infrastructure with its own Indoor Sports Complex. It allowed us to follow the same working model for our team as performed in Noida. Our team first focused on the 20th and 21st working on registration for all teams arriving from various regions. This registration process included checking of documents and passing on jerseys, water bottles, caps and

sporting equipment to each player from each sport for the games. Coaching staff were also provided t-shirts to be worn during the games. Quality competition was ensured through the talent from across the nation went head to head. Officials and referees were acquired for every sport from Nagpur's sports federations. VNIT after covid conducted its first ever public event in its campus, hence it was key to prevent spread of COVID-19. Adequate measures were taken to ensure sanitation with handwashing and sanitizing stations placed throughout the campus.

- For the opening ceremony, Arup Sridhar former Indian Badminton player, Roshni Nadar, Chairman of HCL Technologies, Nidhi Pundhir, Director HCL Foundation, Nagpur's NCC Regional Director along with the Dean of VNIT were all present for the opening ceremony of the games.
- Similar to Noida after registration, a team meeting was conducted, to assign employees for each responsibility. I volunteered and procured the role of being a technical director of football which was situated outside campus. Every sport's schedule was completed on time.
- Games were conducted smoothly with much excitement and even displayed on streaming platforms such as Youtube by the videography team.
- After the conclusion of the games Tamil Nadu was declared as the overall winners. A prize distribution ceremony was carried out where the winners were presented with medals and certificates. Best performing players of the entire tournament in all regional, state and national tournaments were awarded scholarships by HCL Foundation.
- There were many challenges in these games as well. Before the tournament the weather forecast from the India Meteorological Department had predicted that there will be extreme heavy rainfall in Nagpur before and during the dates

planned for the conduction for the games, conditions of few planning venues had deteriorated over this course which led to last minute changes in scheduling and transportation requirements increased massively as venues for few of the games shifted to outside the campus. We tried to find the best possible solution to each problem. As rains reduced the quality of the volleyball and boy's football venues we tried to identify, visit and book the nearest best alternative for these games. It took a duration of a day to visit all the venues shortlisted and then a decision was made. Transportation was pre-planned before the event with the set number of cars and buses already marked and booked. But due to the venues being shifted outside more number of cars and buses could've been used as it increased pressure on the existing vehicles which weren't fulfilling the demand of everyone in tournament running according to a time schedule according to facilities available.

- A problem realised after the tournament was the high injury frequency rate in football. It had rained throughout Nagpur so naturally every field was wet. Due to the ground being the most playable version of a pitch available with minimal puddles of rest of the grounds and having a rocky foundation. Pitch resulted in sometimes players slipping due to mud and more due to the conditions.
- There was scope in improvement according to our performance in this tournament. We could've boosted our transportation capabilities by hiring of buses and more cabs to ease pressure of drivers and ensure smoothness in transition from different venues. We could've also prepared an emergency backup list of sporting venues for each sport according to a quality listing before the tournament just in case there was a requirement to shift venues.

CONCLUSION

To conclude my report, I would like to state that this internship was a great opportunity for me as I got to work with some wonderful people and learnt a lot from them. The internship itself was very rewarding and a learning opportunity. The internship tenure was during our summer holidays and it taught me how important doing something productive is for my mental health. Every day when I had some work to get done, I was excited to finish it properly and send it over to Sandeep Kumar sir, as I felt accomplished by being productive. I did not realise how stale things had become due to the pandemic and staying home all the time with pretty much nothing productive to do. Organizing my day according to the magnitude of work I had was something that I learnt as all of it was done through my self-motivation. To this day, I have been using a very organized mindset towards getting college/internship work done. One of the most useful things I learnt was the importance of digital marketing for any growing business. I could visualize myself benefiting from something like a website in the future when I start my own business/venture. In my opinion, if you can make people believe in the mission of your enterprise, you have successfully sold them your product/service and that's exactly what HCL Foundation stands for and is trying to do.

Reference

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